JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years of hands-on experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical initiatives across fintech and e-commerce sectors. I've spent the last five years mentoring engineering teams, designing microservices architectures, and reducing infrastructure costs by millions through strategic system redesigns. I enjoy solving complex problems involving distributed systems and take pride in writing clear code that other engineers actually want to maintain.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions

Leeds, United Kingdom

www.techvault.io

March 2021 - Present

Led the architectural redesign of our payment processing system, reducing latency by 65% and enabling us to handle 10x throughput. Mentored a team of 6 engineers, conducting code reviews and designing their career development paths with two engineers promoted to senior roles. Established engineering standards and best practices across the platform, including mandatory code review processes and automated testing requirements that reduced production incidents by 72%. Drove the migration from monolithic architecture to microservices, completing the transition over 18 months with zero downtime and improved deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases.

Senior Software Engineer

DataStream Analytics

Manchester, United Kingdom

www.datastream-analytics.co

July 2017 - February 2021

Built a real-time analytics platform processing 2 billion events daily using Apache Kafka and Elasticsearch, serving 150+ enterprise clients. Designed and implemented a distributed caching layer using Redis that improved query response times from 8 seconds to under 400 milliseconds. Took ownership of the database performance team, identifying and fixing critical bottlenecks in production queries that were causing 95th percentile latencies to exceed SLAs. Mentored 4 junior engineers, leading weekly technical discussions and guiding them through complex debugging sessions that improved team problem-solving skills significantly.

Software Engineer

FinTech Dynamics Ltd

London, United Kingdom

www.fintechdynamics.net

September 2009 - June 2017

Developed core transaction processing services in Java handling over 50,000 transactions per second during peak trading hours for institutional clients. Implemented a comprehensive monitoring and alerting system using Prometheus and Grafana that reduced mean time to detection for production issues from 2 hours to 8 minutes. Collaborated with DevOps and Security teams to establish CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment lead time from 6 weeks to 2 hours and significantly improving release reliability. Contributed to open-source projects and published technical blog posts on distributed systems, building a reputation within the engineering community that led to speaking invitations at 3 major conferences.

EDUCATION

University of Leeds

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

2005 - 2009

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, JavaScript, Kotlin

Distributed Systems: Microservices Architecture, Event-Driven Systems, Apache Kafka, Message Queues, Distributed Tracing

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, DynamoDB, MongoDB

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, ECS), Google Cloud Platform, Azure

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Jenkins, CircleCI, GitHub Actions, Linux

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

Caching and Performance: Redis, Memcached, Query Optimization, Load Testing, JMeter

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab, Bitbucket

Testing: JUnit, Mockito, pytest, Integration Testing, Test-Driven Development

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmitchell-tech/distributed-cache-lib - Go library for distributed caching patterns with failover support

github.com/jmitchell-tech/kafka-connector-suite - Collection of custom Kafka connectors for legacy system integrations

github.com/jmitchell-tech/performance-toolkit - Python utilities for load testing and benchmarking microservices

github.com/jmitchell-tech/observability-patterns - Examples and best practices for implementing observability in distributed systems